TC100 combined card

What-did-you-make-of-it question

1. Core move

Ask for their interpretation before giving yours.

Default: "What did you make of it?"

2. Best default

"That sounds like a mixed signal. What did you make of it - or is it too early to tell?"

3. Use when

They described an event, message, result, meeting, reply or interaction, and the facts are clearer than the meaning.

4. Avoid when

They need safety, comfort, privacy, direct action, basic facts, or time before analysis.

5. Calibration

Continue if they pause, think, expand or nuance. Adjust if they look pressured, return to facts, or say they do not know.

6. Recovery

"No pressure to analyse it."

"Too early to tell is a complete answer."

"I did not mean that as a challenge - I was curious about your read."

7. Neighbour rule

TC100 asks for meaning. TC011 checks understanding. TC030 echoes a phrase. TC034 narrows answer options. TC041 selects the live topic. TC040 reflects meaning already implied.

8. Field tip

Ask for their read before offering yours. The win is not getting a deep answer; the win is giving them first right to define what the event means.